

Ryan Bookstein

University of Maryland
Department of Government and Politics
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Education

University of Maryland , College Park, MD	2023 – 2027
M.A., Ph.D., Political Science	
Committee: Kris Miler (Chair), James Gimpel, David Karol, Ernesto Calvo	
Towson University , Towson, MD	2019 – 2023
B.S., Political Science	

Research Interests

American Political Institutions, Elite Behavior, Political Economy, Statistical Methods.

Affiliations

Interdisciplinary Laboratory for Computational Social Science (iLCSS)	2026 –
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Peer-Reviewed Publications

1. Bookstein, Ryan and Kris Miler. 2026. “Party Defection in Senate Confirmations of Executive Nominees.” *Congress & the Presidency*, 53(1), 62–91.

Working Papers

5. Bookstein, Ryan and James Gimpel. “The Geography of Senate Constituency Service: Field Office Siting, Accessibility, and Persistence.” *Under Review*.
4. Bookstein, Ryan and Kris Miler. “Deference or Discipline?: Party Defection and Senator Behavior on Executive Nominations.” *Under Review*.
3. Bookstein, Ryan. “Committees as Vehicles for Issue-Specific Lawmaking Effectiveness.”
2. Bookstein, Ryan and Landon Blacknall. “Informal Constituencies: Neighboring Legislators in Congress”
1. Bookstein, Ryan and Matthew Zinno. “Who Serves the President? A Historical Dataset of American Cabinet Members, 1789 – 2026.”

Works in Progress

4. Bookstein, Ryan. “The Political Economy of the Congressional Staff Labor Market.”
3. Bookstein, Ryan and James Gimpel. “Beyond the Office Door: How Legislators Allocate Staff Across Their Constituencies.”

2. Bookstein, Ryan and Kris Miler. “Legislative Staff and Issue Portfolios in the U.S. Congress.”
1. Bookstein, Ryan and Gideon Ondap. “A Demand-Side Perspective to Constituent Representation.”

Presentations

Annual Meetings:

American Political Science Association	2026
Midwest Political Science Association	2025, 2026

Departmental Workshops:

University of Maryland American Politics Workshop	2025, 2026
University of Maryland Methods Workshop	2026

Invited Talks:

Department of Politics, Law, and Society, Bryant University	2026
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Awards and Grants

University of Maryland American Politics Research Grant	2025
University of Maryland Dean’s Fellowship	2024 – 2027
Georgetown University Political Science Predoctoral Summer Institute Fellow	2022

Teaching

University of Maryland, Instructor of Record:

Data Science Camp for Incoming Ph.D. Students (Graduate)	Summer 2026
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University of Maryland, TA:

Quantitative Methods for Political Science (Graduate)	Fall 2026
The Science (and Politics) of Public Opinion (Undergraduate)	Spring 2026
Scope and Methods for Political Science Research (Undergraduate)	Fall 2025
Advanced Maximum Likelihood Estimation (Graduate)	Fall 2025

Research Experience

University of Maryland:

Research Assistant, Kris Miler	Fall 2023 – Spring 2026
Research Assistant, Shanna Pearson-Merkowitz	Summer 2026 – Fall 2026

Professional Service

University of Maryland:

Graduate Student Workshop Coordinator	2026 –
Reader, Annual Learning Outcome Assessment	2026
Graduate Student Methods Workshop Coordinator	2025
Graduate Student Representative, Department External Review	2025

Technical Skills

R, Python, SPSS, GIS, Excel, L^AT_EX